

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR)
Regional Office for Arab States**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Cairo, Egypt
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Disaster Risk Reduction

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr Raidan ALSAQQAF
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Deputy Chief, Regional Office for Arab States

3. Background information

Created in December 1999, the United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR) is the designated focal point in the United Nations system for the coordination of efforts to reduce disasters and to ensure synergies among the disaster reduction activities of the United Nations and regional organizations and activities in both developed and less developed countries. Led by the United Nations Special Representative of the Secretary-General for Disaster Risk Reduction (SRSG), UNDRR has over 160 staff located in its headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland, and in regional offices. Specifically, UNDRR guides, monitors, analyses and reports on progress in the implementation of the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030, supports regional

and national implementation of the Framework and catalyzes action and increases global awareness to reduce disaster risk working with UN Member States and a broad range of partners and stakeholders, including civil society, the private sector, parliamentarians and the science and technology community.

UNDRR's Regional Office for Arab States works with 22 Countries in the region to provide technical assistance and advisory services to implement DRR-related activities. Support is predominantly directed at the policy-level, with a multitude of local-level initiatives at the municipal and community levels.

The Regional Office has 12 team members working on substantive and operational matters, and the Fellow will be working closely with the deputy chief and the team to implement a pan-Mediterranean project funded by the EC on ecosystem-based approaches to DRR, with emphasis on holistic solutions to prevent and address forest fires.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, and under the overall guidance of the Deputy Chief of the Regional Office, the candidate will perform the following duties:

Project Implementation Support:

- Assist in organizing and facilitating field missions to project sites, including coordination with local stakeholders, preparation of mission briefings, and documentation of findings.
- Assist in coordinating cross-Mediterranean dialogues and multi-stakeholder consultations, including preparing background documents, managing participant communications, and capturing key outcomes.
- Support the documentation of case studies and success stories from field missions to demonstrate practical applications of climate-responsive DRR approaches.

Research and Analysis:

- Conduct literature reviews, data collection, and analysis on forest ecosystems, fire risk mapping, and Ecosystem-based DRR practices in Mediterranean countries.
- Support baseline assessments of forest conditions, ecosystem services, and socio-economic benefits to inform early warning systems and loss and damage baseline.
- Provide synthesis of best practices for climate-responsive DRR frameworks that include adaptive management for forest fire prevention and ecosystem restoration.
- Contribute to policy and technical briefs to inform cross-Mediterranean dialogue around forest management strategies.
- Drafts written outputs, e.g. draft background papers, analysis, sections of reports and studies, inputs to publications, etc. presenting the analysis of the disaster risk in the countries in the region and progress and lessons learned in reducing disaster risk.
- Carries out other duties as assigned by the supervisor

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree in Environmental Science, Forestry, Climate Change, Disaster Risk Reduction, Geography, Environmental Policy, Natural Resource Management, or a related field.

Work experience

One year of experience in biodiversity and environmental research, forest management, climate adaptation, disaster risk reduction, or related areas.

Experience in policy-oriented research is highly desirable.

Languages

Required: English

Desirable: French, Arabic

Other skills

Familiarity with GIS software (ArcGIS, QGIS) or remote sensing tools is an asset.

Competencies

PROFESSIONALISM: Shows pride in work and in achievements; Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter; Is conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines and achieving results; Is motivated by professional rather than personal concerns; Shows persistence when faced with difficult problems or challenges; Remains calm in stressful situations.

TEAMWORK: Works collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals; Solicits input by genuinely valuing others' ideas and expertise; is willing to learn from others; Places team agenda before personal agenda; Supports and acts in accordance with final group decision, even when such decisions may not entirely reflect own position; Shares credit for team accomplishments and accepts joint responsibility for team shortcomings.

PLANNING & ORGANIZING: Develops clear goals that are consistent with agreed strategies; Identifies priority activities and assignments; adjusts priorities as required; Allocates appropriate amount of time and resources for completing work; Foresees risks and allows for contingencies when planning; Monitors and adjusts plans and actions as necessary; Uses time efficiently.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Have a better understanding of the intersection between climate change, disaster risk reduction, and forest management in Mediterranean ecosystems.
- Develop training materials and communication products that make technical information accessible to practitioners and policymakers.
- Build capacity in facilitating regional cooperation mechanisms and cross-border approaches to environmental challenges in the Mediterranean region.
- Conduct comprehensive literature reviews and synthesize research findings on forest ecosystems, climate change adaptation, and Ecosystem-based Disaster Risk Reduction.
- Enhance competencies in project coordination, event management, and international technical cooperation.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Fellow will work closely with the deputy director on this project. He/she/they will establish a workplan following the initial briefing aligned with the project's implementation that will be revisited on quarterly basis and will report biweekly through the POMM.

The Fellow will also work closely with various officers in the team as well as with partners in governments, UN system, and other stakeholders and will revisit the workplan accordingly. The Regional Office will also provide the fellow with all the support needed to deliver on the workplan successfully.

8. Living conditions in the country

Cairo has a well-established expatriate community, affordable cost of living, and accessible healthcare facilities. While traffic congestion and air quality can be challenging, Cairo provides excellent opportunities for cultural immersion and travel across the region.